

CATHOLIC DIOCESE OF BAUCHI

JUSTICE DEVELOPMENT AND PEACE

CARITAS/COMMISSION (JDPC)

JDPC MISEREOR SPONSORED PROJECT

**PROJECT TITLE: IMPROVEMENT OF ACCESS TO WATER AND PEACE
BUILDING**

IN

EIGHT LOCAL GOVERNMENT AREAS IN BAUCHI DIOCESE

PROJECT NO- 131-044-1015ZG

**NARRATIVE REPORT FOR THE PERIOD NOV 1ST, 2022- OCTOBER 31ST,
2023**

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LIST OF ABBREVIATIONS

FGD	Focus Group Discussion
PME	Planning Monitoring and Evaluation
KII	Key Informant Interview
PRA	Participatory Rural Appraisal
PLA	Participatory Learning and Action
VIP	Ventilated Improved Pit
JDPC	Justice Development and Peace Commission
WASH	Water, Sanitation and Hygiene
OD	Open Defecation
LGAs	Local Government Areas
RUWASSA	Rural Water Supply and Sanitation Agency
M&E	Monitoring and Evaluation
DPS	Dialogue and Partnership Service

STRUCTURE OF THE REPORT

The report was prepared by the project team, including field officers, M & E officer, and enumerators. In the course of producing this report, the project team comprising of the Program director/manager as the team lead, M & E Manager, Project managers, field staff, and project foreman; the community stakeholders comprising of the religious leaders, traditional rulers, men, women, and youth group leaders, and community members were all involved in one way or another towards producing this substantive report. Information was gathered through on-site inspections, community feedback, KII, Surveys, PRA/PLA (such as FGD, Observation, Transect walk, and Interviews), and internal records, referencing the objectives and indicators established in the project contract with MISEREOR.

Project Staff: Responsible for community engagement and animation, PME, developing quarterly and monthly action plan, conduct hygiene promotion awareness trainings, peace building activities, monitoring of wells, construction of VIP latrines, Formation of Inter-faith and Peace Clubs, follow up of peace building workshops and report writing, monitoring and review of projects).

Volunteer Staff: Responsible for community mobilization, gathering of raw data from the target groups.

Representatives of the wash committees: Responsible for maintaining and supervising the utilization of the constructed wells and VIP latrines, and providing feedback for better sustainability.

Representatives of the Beneficiary groups: Responsible for conducting monthly regular meetings with group members and reporting back to the field staff.

Monitoring and Evaluation System

JDPC Bauchi has developed an internal monitoring and evaluation system where the project staff develops a quarterly action plan. Monthly action plan by the field staff then follows it. Field staff meet quarterly with communities (the volunteers and WASH committees) to discuss and monitor progress on the availability and quality of safe drinking water, hygiene, and sanitary promotions.

Monthly visit to project implementation side to ascertain the level of construction, conduct one on one (face to face interview with individuals), focus group discussions, conduct monthly meetings with representatives of the targeted wash committees as well as visit to nearby primary health care centers, and clinics to get data or records on the cases of Diarrhea, Typhoid and other water borne disease. In this period, only internal evaluation was conducted on all project implementations and financing covering the period November 2023 – October 2024.

2.0 CHANGES IN PROJECT CONTEXT

2.1 Socio-Economic and Political Changes

The general changes in the project setting (for the period of one year of the project contract starting November 2023 to October 2024) were mainly driven by the state of the country's economy. From 2023 to date, the country (Nigeria) has been experiencing a serious economic recession, which has greatly affected the socio-economic activities of the project settings. In the year 2023, Nigeria had a change of government at both the state and Federal levels across all arms of government. This change in government has brought about increased socioeconomic setbacks. This change has brought about a serious decline in the value of the Nigerian currency, which has in turn negatively affected the socio-economic values of Nigerians, resulting in an accelerated high cost of living. The cost of living has increased by about 400%; this change in cost has drastically affected the initial costing of this project. By November 2023, elections were over in most parts of the country, so political activities had been halted. But due to the pre- and post-election activities and change in government, which set the country in total destabilization, the inhabitants of the country were still trying to adjust to the changes in government, and also to the socio-economic changes that had brought about serious hunger. In 2024, there were areas in the Bauchi Diocese that experienced floods, which claimed many lives and properties, including farm produce. This menace further aggravated the high cost of living in Bauchi Diocese and in Nigeria at large.

Campaign promises have been made by several politicians to provide sources of potable water to different communities. This, however, has made more communities complacent and dependent

on the political promises made by politicians. This is coupled with the economic hardship experienced in Nigeria. In most communities, however, it has been observed that most of the campaign promises of providing safe drinking water were never actualized; as a result, these communities are still vulnerable to a high risk of waterborne diseases.

2.1.1 Economic Characteristics

The people of Bauchi and Gombe States are mostly subsistent farmers, petty traders, and civil servants. Most rural people live in clusters, mostly related by blood or tribal affinity. They merely rely on teamwork within polygamous families to cultivate their farmland. Many of them lack the means for mechanized farming and are unable to afford improved farming implements due to ever-increasing inflation rates. As a result of changes in the Nigerian government and the economic recession in the country (Nigeria), the cost of commodities in the market keeps skyrocketing. This continuous rise in prices adversely affected the living standards of the people, even those in the urban communities.

To make matters worse, the impact of climate change has an additional hard and unbearable effect on women and children who have to wake up very early in the morning, trekking long distances to source water, firewood, prepare food, and the like for family use, due to traditional gender roles and responsibilities.

The poor economic situation of most people makes open defecation a common, acceptable practice and lifestyle amongst the people. Most people find it difficult and a waste of resources to construct latrines in their homes; they prefer going to the bush or hidden areas to pass out their waste.

2.1.2 Changes in the Target Groups

- Our partnership with Misereor in the provision of access to water and sanitation, hygiene program in the Catholic Diocese of Bauchi dates back to 2013. The first phase started with a two-year project period. Before the commencement of the first phase, the water situation in the 6 Local Government Areas was bad. There was a serious problem of

getting access to potable drinking water, high cases of waterborne diseases caused by human and animal activities/sharing the same source of water, communities trekking long distances to collect water, women and children spending more time collecting water, and poor hygiene in the communities.

- The provision of safe drinking water in the targeted 58 communities has brought about ease in doing domestic activities, particularly for women and the girl child. Most women in the target communities do not have to go far distance to source drinking water, thereby saving time and creating opportunity for the girl child to get an education. In general, there is an improved family social life as more women spend more time with their families rather than trekking distances to source and fetch water. The economic situation has also improved significantly, since families can now have more time to go to their farms, do their businesses, and earn more income. This has also led to a reduction in cases of water-related illnesses, as reported through a semi-structured interview conducted
- The provision of good sanitary conditions and good hygiene promotion: In the targeted communities, there was a greater awareness of the ills and dangers of Open Defecation (OD), awareness creation on the use of VIP latrines and good hygiene practices by the hygiene officer and the field staff. Target groups/communities now understand the need for good sanitary conditions and good hygiene practices. The practice of good hygiene by the communities has brought about a reduction in reported illnesses due to improper hygiene. There was also a noticeable reduction in the strict adherence to core traditional practice (the tradition of open defecation on farmland as a source of manure) among men. This is indicated in the increased use of the ventilated pit latrine (VIP).
- The establishment of peace clubs in schools and the formation of interfaith groups in the communities have driven home more awareness on the need for peaceful coexistence, for dialogue and reconciliation. This awareness has brought about relative peace within various communities experiencing unrest, and has awoken the other communities to the need to sustain the peace they have long enjoyed by ensuring to resolve conflicts are resolved in a more peaceful way, such as dialogue. The peace clubs are a way of forming

the young ones from the grassroots to have an in-depth understanding of the need for peace and a peaceful resolution of conflicts when they arise.

2.1.3 Risks and /or Opportunities

Bauchi Diocese, comprising Bauchi and Gombe States, has two major seasons, namely the dry and wet (rainy) seasons. While the wet season lasts for about 6 six months, the dry season also has a duration of 6 six months in one year. Shallow wells and VIP latrines are constructed during the dry season because of the risk associated with the collapse and the deceit of attaining a good water level if dug during the rainy season. This results in the early dry-up of shallow wells during the dry season. JDPC Team and water masons specialists over time were able to factor out that if construction of shallow wells and VIP latrines is carried out during the rainy season, it usually collapses once it rains in communities, which affects proper implementation and construction on site. Therefore, the construction of shallow wells is best done during the dry season. Apart from the fact that shallow wells have the tendency to collapse during the rainy season, it is observed and evident that the water level rises, which is not good for shallow wells. Because interventions are carried out in hard-to-reach areas, the rainy season makes it even more difficult to gain access to benefiting communities, as the access route gets flooded and eroded. The dry season provides JDPC Bauchi with the opportunity to construct wells and VIP latrines before the wet seasons, and be able to observe that the shallow wells are able to yield enough water all year round. Since most of the communities engage in farming as a means of livelihood, access to water is an opportunity for them to engage in dry season farming, thereby having all-year-round farming, and elevating their economic situation. This farming waste can also be used for the production and use of briquettes as an alternative source of clean energy, which will, in turn, curtail deforestation to meet domestic demands for fossil fuel. This opportunity will result in the mitigation or deterrence of activities that will lead to increased climate change.

2.2 Changes in the Organization

- During the project implementation period, there were no internal personnel changes. All project staff were on the ground and available, and projects were implemented using existing personnel.

- During the project implementation period, a change occurred in the office of the Minister for Education in Bauchi State, necessitating another advocacy visit to the Ministry of Education for familiarization purposes. One school mapped out for the formation of a peace club in Dass LGA of Bauchi State was converted into a higher institution, while the students who were studying in the school were dispersed into other schools within the State.

2.3 Implication of Changes

- Since there were no changes with regard to project personnel, the implementation process was smooth and easier, as all personnel are already familiar with the project and implementation process. As a result, there was no need for prolonged unboarding and training of new personnel.
- Changes with regard to external actors could bring about a delay in project implementation, as we are required to map out a new school for the formation of a peace club. The change of the minister for Education could also halt the implementation of peace clubs in schools, resulting in delay or non-achievement of project objectives. So it was necessary to pay an advocacy visit to the new minister for Education.

3.0 PROJECT IMPLEMENTATION

3.1 Objectives Achieved

Project objective 1: 58 selected communities in Bauchi Diocese have improved access to potable water			
Indicators	Baseline value at project launch	Interim value	Current value
Indicator 1.1: 100% of the selected communities have access to potable water at the end of the funding period. <u>Target Value = 48 Wells; 10 Boreholes</u> Indicator 1.2: The trekking distance and waiting time for water collection in the target communities are reduced to a maximum of 500 meters and 30 minutes. <u>Target Value = 100%</u>	<u>Baseline Value</u> = <u>0</u> in November 2022		24 Wells constructed; 6 Boreholes installed Current Value = 51.7% October 2023
	<u>Baseline Value</u> = <u>0%</u>at November 2022		Current Value = 33.6% October 2023
<u>Project objective 2: 56 selected communities in Bauchi Diocese have improved their sanitation and hygiene</u>			

standards and reduced incidences of water-related diseases.			
<u>Indicator 2(a):</u> Water-borne diseases (such as Cholera, Typhoid, Diarrhea, etc.) are reduced by 20% in the targeted communities at the end of the funding period. <u>Target Value = 20%</u>	<u>Baseline Value</u> = <u>85%</u> in November 2022		Current Value = 81% October 2023
	<u>Baseline Value</u> = <u>0%</u> in November 2022		Current Value = 25% October 2023
<u>Project objective 3:Peaceful co-existence is fostered through ethno-religious dialogue, mediation and reconciliation, and peaceful cooperation for community development</u>			
<u>Indicator 3.1:</u> The number of conflicts in the targeted communities has reportedly decreased compared to the previous situation.	<u>Baseline Value</u> = <u>70%</u> in November 2022		Current Value = 68% October 2023
	<u>Baseline Value</u> = <u>0%</u> in November 2022		Current Value = 18% October 2023
<u>Indicator 3.2:</u> The concerned stakeholders, leaders, interfaith/ethnic groups, and peace clubs apply content learned through the project activities in their defined roles within the Emergency Preparedness			

and Response Teams (EPRT).			
<u>Target Value = 100%</u>			

3.2 Current Status of Implementation

Objectives	Planned activities	Planned output	Implemented activities/ Output	Estimated target group population	Cooperation with target groups
<u>Project objective 1:</u> 58 selected communities in Bauchi Diocese have improved access to potable water	New wells constructed	48	24	7,300	Increased acceptance and involvement of stakeholders - Readiness by the target community for development
	Drilling and installation of new boreholes	10	6	3,800	
<u>Project objective 2:</u> 56 selected communities in Bauchi Diocese have improved	Construction of new VIP latrines	56	14	4,957	- Willingness to provide local contributions
	Community	58	26	10,310	

their sanitation and hygiene standards and reduced incidences of water-related diseases.	sensitization on sanitation and hygiene				- Readiness by the - target community for development - Common understanding of the project
<u>Project objective 3:</u> Peaceful co-existence is fostered through ethno-religious dialogue, mediation and reconciliation, and peaceful cooperation for community development	2-day workshop on Basic concepts of peace building, Conflict Resolution, Dialogue, Reconciliation and Mediation, Emergency preparedness and Response (EPR), Early Warning and Early Response (EWER).	1	0	0	
	Advocacy visit, consultative meetings, and dialogue with key stakeholders	58	25	250	
	Workshop for stakeholders on Peacebuilding, Dialogue, Reconciliation, and Mediation	1			
	Training of selected members of interfaith	1	0	0	

	groups				
	Strengthening of existing peace/interfaith groups and peace clubs through town hall meetings in the previous 60 communities.	60	20	120	
	Formation of interfaith groups	10	0	0	
	Mentoring of the newly formed 10 interfaith groups.	10	0	0	
	Formation of Peace Clubs	12	2	134	

3.2.1 Status of Activities Implemented and Generated Output

Key activities implemented	Generated output
Construction of shallow wells	24 shallow wells were constructed
Drilling and installation of Boreholes	6 hand pump boreholes installed
Construction of ventilated pit latrines,	14 ventilated pit latrines constructed
2-day workshop on Basic concepts of peace building, Conflict Resolution, Dialogue, Reconciliation and Mediation, Emergency preparedness and Response (EPR), Early Warning and Early Response (EWER).	In Progress
Workshop for stakeholders on Peacebuilding, Dialogue, Reconciliation, and Mediation	In Progress
Formation of Peace Clubs in Schools	2 Peace Clubs formed in 2 selected schools
Advocacy visit, consultative meetings, and dialogue with key stakeholders	26 Advocacies done
Strengthening of existing peace/interfaith groups and peace clubs through town hall meetings in the previous 60 communities.	20 strengthening done
Community sensitization on sanitation and hygiene	26 awareness done
Formation of 10 new interfaith groups	In Progress
Follow-up mentoring of the team of trainees as they conduct similar workshops	In Progress
Staff training/Studies	2 done

3.3 Unintended Effects Generated by the Project

The most common unintended positive effect observed and as reported by the beneficiaries was the fact that the intervention has helped them to generate more income for their families. This was possible as a result of the now available time they have to carry out their farming activities, thereby having more yield from their farms for sale.

The women also spoke that the intervention has also helped them to have more time to go to the market for their daily petty businesses, which enables them to generate more income for the daily running of their families, since they now have better health and access to potable water.

Another unintended negative effect observed was the fact that some shallow wells constructed are not enough to serve the needs of a community due to the population of the community. This situation brings about overcrowding at the water collection point, which can lead to a bit of conflict as against the intended positive effect of peace.

3.4 Evaluation

In this project period, only internal evaluation and reviews were carried out by the JDPC team to evaluate and review what has been done, what needs to be improved upon, and the general impact on persons within communities of intervention. Monitoring of project progress was also done by the JDPC team throughout the life of the project.

4.0 INTERIM CONCLUSIONS

- This project was designed to achieve 3 specific objectives, which are the provision of 58 sources of potable water for 58 communities, which include 48 shallow wells and 10 hand-pump boreholes. Also, to improve the sanitation and hygiene standards of 56 communities by constructing 56 VIP latrines in public places, sanitation and hygiene sensitisation and awareness campaigns, and also by constituting WASH committees in

the benefiting communities to reduce the incidences of water and sanitation-related diseases. Thirdly, to foster peaceful coexistence through ethno-religious dialogue, mediation and reconciliation, and peaceful cooperation for community development through the establishment of 22 inter-faith/peace groups, including 12 peace clubs in schools, and ensuring that these peace groups organise workshops in their communities to promote peaceful co-existence. All these objectives are geared towards improving the living standard of the people in the rural communities through peaceful co-existence and the provision of WASH facilities. Objectives 1 and 2 mentioned above have attained over 40% achievement with regard to implementation, outcome, and a bit of impact. Objective 3 is still in progress, with just about 7% achievement.

- During the project implementation, the JDPC project team has learnt to consider possible risks and how to mitigate them. The team has learnt to carry out construction works more in the dry season rather than in the rainy season. JDPC has also learnt to carry out an inclusive project, regardless of gender, race, religion, ethnicity, and status. The communities have also learnt the importance of owning the project, thereby participating at all levels of the project life cycle, and also through local contribution.
- The community gateway. The point of entry into any community is vital to the success of every project. The involvement of stakeholders and religious leaders at the beginning, during, and at the handover of the project played a vital role in the survival of the project. This strategy of involving religious leaders and community stakeholders gave the project better acceptance by the communities. The development of WASH committees in all the communities has been helpful; the communities have ownership of the project.

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ANNEXES

ANNEX 1: ANALYSIS

Table 1: Analysis of VIP Latrines

<i>S/N</i>	<i>LOCATION</i>	<i>PLANNED</i>	<i>COMPLETED</i>	<i>ONGOING</i>	<i>REMARK</i>
1	Tafawa Balewa	2	2	0	Target met
2	Bogoro	7	7	0	Target met
3	Ganjuwa	2	0	2	In progress
4	Kaltungo	8	1	7	In progress
5	Shongom	10	0	10	In progress
6	Toro	7	0	7	In progress
7	Dass	10	4	6	In progress
8	Balanga	10	0	10	In progress
	TOTAL	56	14	42	

Table 2: Analysis of Wells

<i>S/N</i>	<i>LOCATION</i>	<i>PLANNED</i>	<i>COMPLETED</i>	<i>ONGOING</i>	<i>REMARK</i>
1	Tafawa Balewa	3	3	0	Target met
2	Bogoro	5	5	0	Target met
3	Ganjuwa	3	0	3	In progress
4	Kaltungo	6	6	0	Target met
5	Shongom	9	4	5	In progress
6	Toro	5	0	5	In progress
7	Dass	8	4	4	In progress
8	Balanga	9	2	7	In progress
	TOTAL	48	24	24	

Table 3: Analysis of Boreholes

<i>S/N</i>	<i>LOCATION</i>	<i>PLANNED</i>	<i>COMPLETED</i>	<i>ONGOING</i>	<i>REMARK</i>
1	Tafawa Balewa	1	1	0	Target met
2	Bogoro	1	1	0	Target met
3	Ganjuwa	0	0	0	Target met
4	Kaltungo	1	0	1	In progress
5	Shongom	2	1	1	In progress
6	Toro	1	1	0	Target met
7	Dass	2	1	1	In progress
8	Balanga	2	1	1	In progress
	TOTAL	10	6	4	

Table 5: Analysis of Peace Clubs

<i>S/N</i>	<i>LOCATION</i>	<i>PLANNED</i>	<i>COMPLETED</i>	<i>ONGOING</i>	<i>REMARK</i>
1	Tafawa Balewa	Nil	Nil	Nil	Nil
2	Bogoro	2	2	0	Target met
3	Ganjuwa	2	0	2	In progress
4	Kaltungo	2	0	2	In progress
5	Shongom	2	0	2	In progress
6	Toro	Nil	Nil	Nil	Nil
7	Dass	2	0	2	In progress
8	Balanga	2	0	2	In progress
	TOTAL	12	2	10	

ANNEX 2: PHOTO SPEAKS



Ongoing construction of hand pump Borehole





Advocacy visit to communities



Commissioning of Boreholes by the Bishop



Completed Latrine and Shallow Well





Formation of Peace Clubs.



Strengthening of existing interfaith groups.





Completed Latrine and Shallow Well